

Context Lore — Bones for Brainstorming

This is **bones, not a skeleton**: just the named things and structural hooks the mechanics already imply, with **no lore written in**. Everything here is a peg to hang a story on — invent freely. Nothing below is itself lore; it's the list of slots that want lore.

One-line premise the mechanics imply: it's a roguelite take on the card game **Regicide** — heroes fight up through a realm to **kill the crowned royals** (Jacks → Queens → Kings). "Regicide" = the killing of kings. That's the whole spine. Everything else is open.

Named things that need a story (locked terms — keep the names)

- **Province** — one run / one region you push through. Numbered (Province 1, 2, 3...). Implied: a **Kingdom map** of regions you unlock and travel. *Why are there provinces? Who rules them? Why claim them in order?*
- **Act** — a leg of the journey inside a province. Three of them: **Jacks → Queens → Kings**. *What rises as you go deeper?*
- **The three climaxes** (these want the most flavor — they're the boss moments):
 - **Gate** (the Jacks fight)
 - **Courtyard** (the Queens fight)
 - **Throne** (the Kings fight — the final one)
- **Kingdom** — the meta layer / the world that persists between runs. The map, plus what you permanently unlock. *Whose kingdom? Are you taking it or saving it?*
- **Candle** — placeholder name for the currency you bank **when a run ends in death**, spent back in the Kingdom. **Name is up for grabs** — needs a lore-driven one. *What is a candle, in-world? What does spending one mean?*
- **Camp** — the rare rest stop on the road (resets your deck, lets you plan). The scarcest, most precious moment in a province. *What is a camp here? Who's there?*
- **The deck (52 cards)** — framed in design as your **life source / engine**, not a collection. *Is the deck the party's stamina? Fate? Something diegetic?*

Roadside places (each is a landmark type — a vignette slot)

- Lair
- Forge
- Shrine
- Tower
- Market
- Abbey

- Generic fights (skirmish / veteran / elite)
- **Events.**

Each wants a one-line sense of place.

The heroes (classes — names locked, personalities open)

These are all placeholder names, just to give idea on brainstorming. Players select heroes and go through the process. Here are some names:

- Commander
- Executioner
- Exile
- Gambler
- Oracle
- Quartermaster
- Sentinel
- Surgeon
- Warden.

Each has a mechanical identity already; none has a backstory.

Who are they, why do they march, how do they relate?

Tone pegs (only what the mechanics suggest — not prescriptive)

- Death is meant to feel like "**an opportunity, not a failure**" (you come back wider/stronger next run). A lore frame for *why* dying advances you would be gold.
- The fantasy is **personal engine-building** — a player should be able to say "I ran *this* hero + *this* build and it felt like mine." Lore that makes builds feel like identities, not stat-sheets, supports that.

That's the lot. Pick any peg and run.